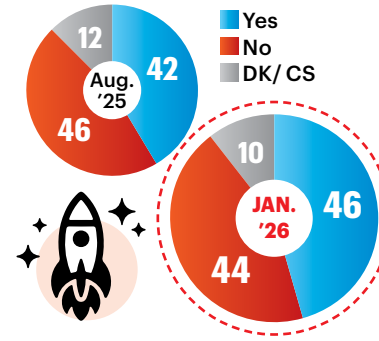


SHOPPERS' DELIGHT Customers at an IKEA store in Delhi

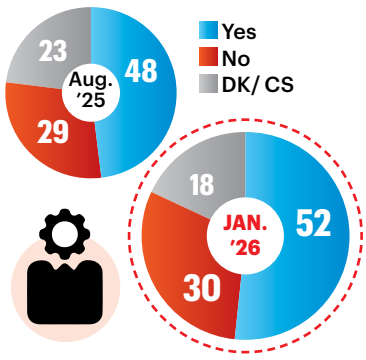
ARUN KUMAR

Q. Do you think the govt has provided enough support to small businesses and startups?



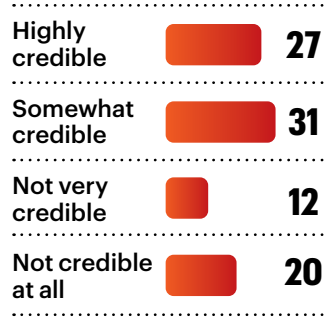
Govt support to small businesses divides opinion almost down the middle

Q. Do you think the bureaucracy is a hindrance to India's economic development?



Majority increasingly see bureaucracy as an obstacle to economic growth

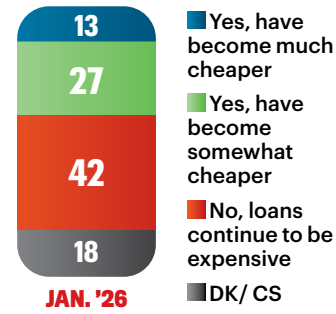
Q. How credible do you find the economic and statistical data released by the Indian government?



Rest, DK/ CS

Official economic data enjoys majority trust, even as doubts persist

Q. Have bank loans become cheaper after the RBI's 125 basis points rate cut last year?



Most say loans remain expensive despite significant RBI rate cuts

cent say their situation has 'worsened'. Around 45.7 per cent feel the government has provided enough support to small businesses and start-ups, up from 41.5 per cent in the previous survey, but 44 per cent think otherwise. Despite steep RBI rate cuts, 42 per cent still view loans as 'expensive', and 51.8 per cent see bureaucracy as a barrier to economic growth, up from 48.3 per cent in August 2025.

Economic anxieties extend to those engaged in agriculture. A whopping majority (85.6 per cent) want the government to legally guarantee the minimum support price (MSP) for agricultural produce.

Recent quarters indicate that India has made some progress, but sustaining it will be crucial. February will bring a revision of the GDP, with a shift in the base year from 2011-12 to 2022-23, which could produce higher—or glossier—numbers. Interestingly, 58.4 per cent of the respondents find official economic data 'highly' or 'somewhat' credible. In any case, the government's task is cut out: push reforms to sustain growth. ■

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say